

UNDERSTANDING MILITARY MOS CODES

How military training and occupational specialties translate into college credit toward an associate degree

 Transfer Credit Evaluation

 Joint Services Transcript (JST)

WHAT IS A MILITARY OCCUPATIONAL SPECIALTY?

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- ▶ **MOS Definition:** The code the Army uses to identify a soldier's specific job role and technical training (e.g., Infantryman, Combat Medic).
- ▶ **Structure:** MOS codes combine numbers and letters indicating the specific career field/branch.
- ▶ **Branch Equivalents:** Other services use different terminology for the same concept:
 - Air Force = **AFSC** | Navy = **NEC/Rating** | Marine Corps = **MOS**

18D

SPECIAL FORCES MEDICAL SERGEANT

"18" = Special Forces Branch | "D" = Medical Specialty



WHAT ARE SKILL LEVELS?

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CAREER PROGRESSION INDICATOR

Skill level shows **how far** a soldier has progressed within their MOS. It measures technical proficiency, rank, scope of responsibility, and leadership expertise.

Rather than just identifying job duties, it reflects a soldier's development from hands-on technician to senior manager within their specialty.



FIVE STANDARD INCREMENTS

For enlisted soldiers, skill levels run in five distinct increments: **10, 20, 30, 40, 50**.

It is represented as the 4th character of a complete MOS code (e.g., **68W10** indicates an entry-level combat medic performing technical tasks).

DETERMINING SKILL LEVELS

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Skill levels are tied primarily to **rank/paygrade**, **time in role**, and mandatory **Professional Military Education (PME)** schooling.



MILITARY TRAINING TO COLLEGE CREDIT

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- ▶ **Direct Coursework Overlap:** Intensive MOS training closely mirrors standard university and community college course curricula.
- ▶ **Institutional Evaluation:** Colleges evaluate Joint Services Transcripts (JST) and award transfer credit for equivalent courses.
- ▶ **Accelerated Degree Completion:** MOS training directly translates into credits toward associate degrees, shortening required classroom hours.
- ▶ **Advanced MOS Impact:** Special Forces (ARSOF) and technical specialties receive extensive credits due to intensive tactical and technical instruction.

SPECIAL FORCES (ARSOF) MOS GROUP

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SPECIAL FORCES (18 SERIES)

- **18B:** Weapons Sergeant
- **18C:** Engineer Sergeant
- **18D:** Medical Sergeant
- **18E:** Communications Sergeant
- **18F:** Asst Operations & Intel
- **18Z:** Operations Sergeant



CIVIL AFFAIRS & PSYOP

- **37F:** Psychological Operations
- **38B/R/S:** Civil Affairs Specialist
- **38W:** Civil Affairs Medical Sergeant

Specialized training in regional analysis, cultural engagement & tactical trauma.



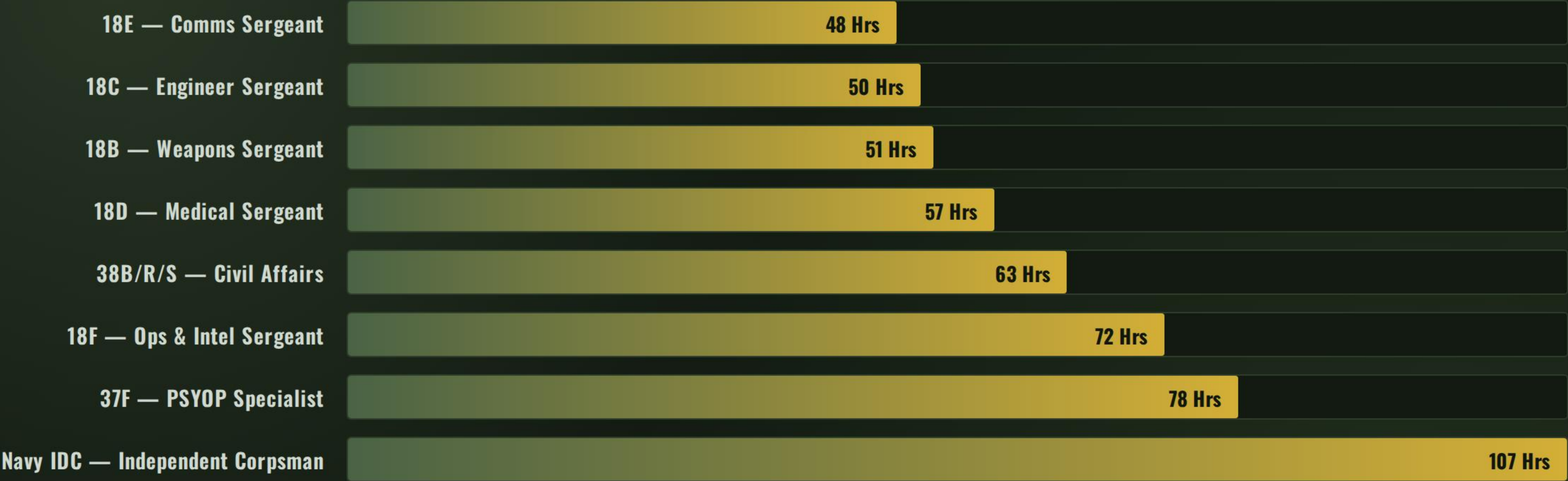
JOINT EQUIVALENTS

- **Navy IDC:** Independent Duty Corpsman

Navy Special Operations equivalent providing autonomous medical and clinical care in deep-sea or expeditionary environments.

COLLEGE CREDIT EARNED BY MOS

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i AAS Degree Target: 64 Credit Hours. Advanced bridging pathways (e.g. Navy IDC & 18D Bridging) exceed standard major totals by satisfying additional elective and general education requirements.

EXAMPLE MAPPING: 18D SF MEDIC

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COURSE CODE	COLLEGE COURSE TITLE	CREDITS AWARDED
EMS 110	Emergency Medical Technician (EMT)	9 Credit Hours
BIO 163	Basic Anatomy & Physiology	5 Credit Hours
EMS 122	EMS Clinical Practicum I	1 Credit Hour
EPT 150	EMS Incident Management	3 Credit Hours
EPT 275	Emergency Operations Center Management	3 Credit Hours
CJC 170	Critical Incident Management	3 Credit Hours

Degree Fit Takeaway: 18D medical training lines up directly with FTCC's Emergency Medical Science / Health Sciences programs, giving soldiers a rapid pathway to degree completion.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR STUDENTS

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UPFRONT CREDIT

Your MOS training translates directly into official college credit before you take your first traditional class on campus.



TARGETED DEGREE SELECTION

Because credits cluster in specific subjects, your MOS points you directly toward the associate degree with the highest credit transfer yield.



CAREER CLUSTER PATHS

- **18D / 38W:** Health Sciences
- **18F / 37F:** Criminal Justice / Homeland Security
- **38B/R/S:** Emergency Management / Human Services

FROM MOS TO DEGREE PLAN

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STEP 1

Submit JST

Student enrolls and submits
official Joint Services
Transcript & MOS history.

STEP 2

Evaluation

Academic advisors evaluate
training against course
equivalency tables.

STEP 3

Credit Awarded

Student receives official
transfer credit for
equivalent military courses.

STEP 4

Streamlined Plan

Remaining required
courses are identified to
complete the degree fast.

Key Takeaways & Next Steps

Your military service represents substantial college-level learning. Make your training work toward your degree.

MOS & Skill Level Impact: MOS identifies what you trained for; skill level reflects your progression and leadership maturity.

Fastest Path to Completion: Aligning your MOS with the right degree program maximizes credit transfer and minimizes required coursework.



Bring your Joint Services Transcript (JST) to an Academic Advisor Today

IMAGE SOURCES

MIL-SPEC



https://www.goarmy.com/content/dam/goarmy/content-splits/special-forces-gille_sm.jpg

Source: www.goarmy.com



https://as1.ftcdn.net/v2/jpg/19/33/24/06/1000_F_1933240690_OAC5VzwJjY0okQAqc8xNXdnARRK1q5HO.jpg

Source: www.posters.cz